

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

Managing the risks associated with providing an optimal level of safety for persons working in or near traffic and the impact of road work on road users, road congestion and the general community, is a significant issue for road agencies and industry. Road agencies and industry have a legislative requirement as an employer of construction, operational and maintenance services to provide a safe work environment and to manage the risks of working in or near traffic through current jurisdictional Work Health and Safety (WHS) requirements, regulation, training and roadwork planning.

The Austroads Guide to Temporary Traffic Management (AGTTM) details the contemporary temporary traffic management practice of member organisations. In doing so, it provides guidance to designers in the production of safe, economical and efficient temporary traffic management designs. This Guide recognises the level of variability of the road environments for which guidance is provided. The guidance provided in AGTTM is intended to encourage the consistent planning, design and implementation of temporary traffic management across Australia and New Zealand while also supporting the streamlined safe progress of work. It applies to all works on roads and near roads, in addition to off road development and other activities that interact with and impact on the road environment.

The purpose of the AGTTM is to provide guidance and supporting material that:

- supports the ability of road agencies and industry to meet their WHS requirements and lead to improved safety outcomes at road worksites
- improves the standard of temporary traffic management in Australia and New Zealand through consistency of application which assists road users to recognise and understand temporary traffic management, thereby improving their behaviour and safety
- aims to reduce the rate of incidents occurring at worksites
- improves the ability of road authorities and industry to manage the increasing frequency and variety of activities that are being undertaken on and near the road
- allows continuous industry review to maintain best practice.

This purpose is achieved through:

- providing direction for all matters relating to the planning, design and implementation of temporary traffic management
- facilitating improved adaptation to changes in technology and practices through being reactive to changes and being able to readily include new innovations
- providing guidance focused on the users of this Guide
- providing road agencies and industry with uniform practices whilst carrying out works on or near roads.

The benefits associated with uniform guidance broadly accepted by jurisdictions and industry include:

- guidance and training that appropriately develop designers with the skills necessary to develop and deliver safe traffic management at road worksites
- reduced impost on industry working across jurisdictional borders
- improved harmonisation of road worksites across jurisdictions providing improved consistency for road users, including vulnerable road users such as pedestrians and cyclists. This is targeted at improving road user behaviour, safety of road worksites and reducing impact on road congestion and the general community.